

**Date:** 30<sup>th</sup> August 2026

**To:** The Editor-in-Chief, International Journal on Document Analysis and Recognition (IJ DAR)

**Subject:** Submission of Manuscript — "Telugu Handwritten Word Recognition Using an Autoregressive Transformer Decoder with Joint CTC-Attention Training"

Dear Editor,

We are pleased to submit our manuscript titled "Telugu Handwritten Word Recognition Using an Autoregressive Transformer Decoder with Joint CTC-Attention Training" for consideration as an original research article in the International Journal on Document Analysis and Recognition.

Telugu, spoken by over 80 million people, has received limited attention in the handwritten text recognition community despite its complex syllabic structure. In this work, we compare a CTC baseline against an autoregressive Transformer decoder trained with a joint CTC-attention loss on the IIIT-HW-Telugu benchmark. Our best model achieves 3.66% character error rate, the lowest lexicon-free result reported on this dataset to our knowledge — a 20% relative reduction from the previous best of 4.58%.

We believe this work is a strong fit for IJ DAR because it directly addresses document analysis challenges for an underserved Indic script, provides a controlled comparison between two dominant decoding strategies, identifies a practical deployment trade-off (autoregressive collapse vs. CTC substitution errors), and releases all code and trained models publicly.

We confirm that:

- This manuscript has not been published elsewhere and is not under consideration by another journal.
- All authors have approved the manuscript and agree with its submission to IJ DAR.
- The authors declare no conflicts of interest.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

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